

```
margin:0 5px 5px 0;
}
```

Here, as well as define the float, right and bottom margins have been declared using shorthand to ensure the text surrounding the image will not sit against its edges. The float should work and in that the image is indeed floating to the left, and the paragraph text is flowing around it to the right, spaced away nicely by the declared margin. The problem, however, is that the containing `<div>` (container) doesn't recognise the float, and as a result it is not expanding vertically to contain the `<image_float>` element, only the now-less-tall paragraph. It must therefore be a good time to look at clearing floats.

8.2 Clearing floats

Elements following a floated element will wrap around that floated element. For example, if an image floats left and is followed by paragraph text, that text will wrap around the image and continue directly underneath it if long enough. If you do not wish this to happen, you can apply the clear property to those elements that follow the float. Four options are available for the clear property: 'left', 'right', 'both' and 'none'

8.2.1 clear:left

By specifying clear:left rule, the element moves below the bottom outer edge of any left-floated elements. Consider the following HTML.

```
<h2>Clearing left</h2>
<div class="floatbox"></div>
<p>This paragraph is being cleared left, so it will be
moved below the bottom outer edge of the floated gray
box.</p>
```

Some simple CSS selectors are used first to define paragraph properties and second a simple gray box that will be floated left.

```
p {
font-size:100%;
line-height:150%;
}

.floatbox {
float:left;
```